

Munshi *Naan*

from the kitchen of Yahya

MAKES 4 • RISE 60–90 MIN • COOK 2–3 MIN EACH

Soft, pillowy, and weighed to the gram. The yogurt is what keeps the crumb tender instead of bready, and the ghee off the heat gives it that glossy, restaurant-style finish. Measured, not guessed — so it comes out the same every time.

a photo of the naan goes here ♦

fresh off the tava

INGREDIENTS

All-Purpose Flour	240 g
Active Dry Yeast (Khamir)	3 g
Sugar	4 g
Warm Milk (or water)	120 g
Salt	4.5 g
Plain Yogurt	30 g
Ghee (or melted butter)	14 g

Milk warm, not hot — ~105°F (40°C). Above 115°F (46°C) kills the yeast.

METHOD

- 1 Bloom the yeast.** Stir the yeast and sugar into the warm milk (120 g, ~105°F / 40°C). Stand 5–10 min until foamy. No foam means dead yeast — start over.
- 2 Mix.** Combine flour (240 g) and salt (4.5 g). Add the yogurt (30 g), ghee (14 g) and the yeast milk. Mix to a shaggy dough.
- 3 Knead.** 8–10 min by hand (or 5 min in a stand mixer on medium) until smooth, soft and slightly tacky. It should spring back when pressed.
- 4 First rise.** Cover and rest in a warm spot 60–90 min, until doubled.
- 5 Divide & shape.** Knock back, divide into 4 equal pieces (~102 g each). Ball them, cover, rest 10 min so the gluten relaxes.
- 6 Roll.** Roll or stretch each into a teardrop ~8 in long, ~1/4 in thick.
- 7 Cook hot.** Screaming-hot cast-iron skillet or tava, 2–3 min total — flip once big bubbles form and the underside is charred in spots.
- 8 Finish.** Brush with extra ghee straight off the heat. Keep wrapped in a towel until serving so they stay soft.

Yahya's note: weigh everything. The yogurt is not optional — it is what makes the crumb tender. If the dough fights the roll, let it rest another 5 min; relaxed gluten rolls thin without tearing.